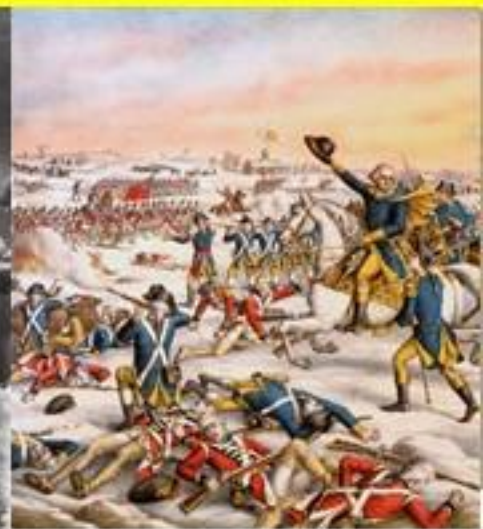


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE - 15

EUROPE AFTER NAPOLEON

EUROPE AFTER NAPOLEON

- 1** The ascendancy of Napoleon in France as a result of the French revolution proved to be a watershed in the history of Europe.
- 2** Napoleon conquered a large part of Europe and these conquests were much marred by the ideals of the French revolution i.e., Liberty, Equality and Fraternity.
- 3** The political existence of the Napoleonic Empire was short but it was an event with intense implications in the history of Europe.
- 4** It brought Europe into contact with the ideas and institutions of France and thereby shook the foundation of the social and political structure of Europe. It was thus the Revolution in European context.
- 5** These ideals of the Revolution got intensified through the Napoleonic wars not just as result of these but also against the reaction to the conquests.



EUROPE AFTER NAPOLEON

- 6 People of the other European countries viewed Napoleon as the liberator.
- 7 They envisaged that the conquests of Napoleon would liberate them from the absolute monarchy and replace it by the liberal and the democratic regime.
- 8 Thus Napoleon was initially welcomed by the people of the other European countries which were conquered.
- 9 However when the people realized that conquests of Napoleon had just replaced an absolute despot by another the popular reaction against his rule was natural.
- 10 This also united the people of the Napoleonic Empire and act as a catalyst to promote nationalism and the ideals like liberty and equality.



EUROPE AFTER NAPOLEON

- 11 It won't be an exaggeration to say that French revolution and Napoleonic wars proved detrimental for the absolute monarchy and the old order in the Europe.
- 12 The strong foundation for the modern day states and institutions were built as a result of these. Nonetheless the monarchs and their respective nobility of Europe failed to realize these popular aspirations of people.
- 13 The vested interests of these sections made them reactionary and status quasits. Monarchs of Europe at this juncture wanted to restore the old order at any cost.
- 14 This was explicitly reflected from the arrangements they came up with after the defeat of Napoleon in 1815.



DEFEAT OF NAPOLEON AND RECONSTRUCTION OF EUROPE

- 1** The seventh coalition of the European powers defeated Napoleon in the Battle of Waterloo in 1815.
- 2** The seventh Coalition comprised of an Anglo-Allied army under the command of the Duke of Wellington combined with a Prussian army under the command of Gebhardt von Blücher.
- 3** The coalition forces defeated France and restored King Louis XVIII to the French throne, the ideals of Revolution. Napoleon abdicated, surrendered to the British, and was exiled to Saint Helena, where he died in 1821.



Britain, Austria, Prussia, Russia emerged as the dominant powers. Napoleon was defeated and the absolute monarchy was restored in France against the ideals of Revolution.

DEFEAT OF NAPOLEON AND RECONSTRUCTION OF EUROPE

- 4** France was defeated by the group of countries ruled by the reactionary monarchs. But the people of Europe in general and France in particular had tasted the ideals of Liberty, Equality and Fraternity.
- 5** The Napoleonic wars had taken these ideals to every nook and corner of Europe. Moreover the Napoleonic wars had fractured the boundaries of nations and empires.
- 6** The immediate task in front of the victorious powers at this juncture was reconstruction of Europe according to the old order and to check the growth of the popular ideals generated by the Revolution.



CONGRESS OF VIENNA (1815)

- 1** An assembly of the victorious powers met in Vienna after the defeat of Napoleon in 1815 to resettle the perturbed continent. This is popularly known as Congress of Vienna.
- 2** Although nearly all the European countries sent their delegates and diplomats to the congress but the main business of the congress was transacted by the four Great Powers which had taken the lead in defeating Napoleon- England, Russia, Austria and Prussia.
- 3** The congress was presided over by **Metternich**, the Austrian minister and a diplomat par excellence.



Metternich

CONGRESS OF VIENNA (1815)

4 The labors of the congress were mainly determined by three Principles

1

The balance of Power which would provide effective safeguards for the future peace of Europe.

2

The principle of legitimacy whereby pre-revolutionary conditions were to be restored as far as possible.

3

The reward to the victors and retribution to the defeated.

5 The term balance of Power meant that the congress envisaged preventing the extensive expansion of any one great power in Europe, such as that Napoleon had brought about.



CONGRESS OF VIENNA (1815)

- 6 The altruistic attitude of the national representatives present and supported the overall purpose of preventing future widespread conflict.
- 7 Since France was the epicenter of Revolution the final settlement at the congress of Vienna redistributed the territories in such a manner as to prevent any one of them from becoming too powerful, the spoils were distributed in order to create buffer against France.
- 8 France was encircled with the strong European powers. This was formally done under the principle of Security.

The states near or adjacent to France were enlarged to act as a buffer against France.



CONGRESS OF VIENNA (1815)

- 9 Another important goal of congress was to restore legitimate or traditional governments to power and to prevent political revolutions in Europe. In other words, the goal was to maintain status quo and the old order.

Thus the following changes were made in order to reinstate the absolute monarchy:

DYNASTY	RESTORED TO
BOURBONS	FRANCE, SPAIN AND NAPLES
HOUSE OF SAVOY	SARDINIA – PIEDMONT
HOUSE OF ORANGE	HOLLAND
GERMAN PRINCES	CONFEDERATION OF RHINE
POPE	CENTRAL ITALY



CRITICISM OF CONGRESS OF VIENNA

- 1** Although redistribution of Europe that Congress of Vienna envisaged could preserve relative peace in Europe for decades, yet it was not without faults.
- 2** The strongest criticism of the congress points towards its disregard for nationalistic sentiments.
- 3** These nationalistic attitudes and sentiments were well established by the time of congress.
- 4** But instead of unifying territories and their people by shared and common language and culture, the congress established boundaries from the purview national interests of the victorious powers for maintaining the balance of power in Europe.



CRITICISM OF CONGRESS OF VIENNA

- 5** The consequences of this oversight were soon felt in the ripples of revolution in the years following.
- 6** In a nut shell though the Congress may have made momentous progress in diplomacy and maintain the stability of Europe, It was rarely done with the common people in mind and often at the sacrifice of their rights.



The ascendancy of Napoleon	Watershed in the history- conquered a large part of Europe- marred by the ideals of the French revolution- brought Europe into contact with the ideas and institutions of France- shook the foundation of the social and political structure of Europe- got intensified through the Napoleonic wars
Other European countries	People of the other European countries- Napoleon as the liberator- would liberate them from the absolute monarchy- welcomed by the people
Napoleon's despotic rule	Napoleon had just replaced an absolute despot by another- united the people of the Napoleonic Empire- promote nationalism
Monarchs of Europe	Restore the old order- after the defeat of Napoleon.
Battle of Waterloo	Seventh coalition of the European powers defeated Napoleon- restored King Louis XVIII to the French throne-
Anglo-Allied army	Britain, Austria, Prussia, Russia- dominant power

Result of Napoleonic wars	Ideals to every nook and corner of Europe - fractured the boundaries-Nationalism
Congress of Vienna	An assembly of the victorious powers met in Vienna - to resettle the perturbed continent - presided over by Metternich- redistributed the territories- to prevent any one of them from becoming too powerful - create buffer against France
Concert of Europe	Enforce the decisions of the Congress of Vienna - headed by Prince Metternich - establish an international society to maintain the peace
Criticism of Congress of Vienna	Disregard for nationalistic sentiments- established boundaries - purview national interests of the victorious powers - ripples of revolution

QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. How did the Congress of Vienna represent the interests and views of European conservatives?
150 words
2. Why and how did Congress of Vienna attempt to contain France?
150 words
3. Do you agree that Congress of Vienna was a success? Justify your answer.
150 words

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